



GREY BANNER ALERT



mainroads
WESTERN AUSTRALIA

SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	21 st April 2026	Time of Incident	2:00 PM
Directorate / Region	RMO – Kimberley Region	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
isafe Event Type	Injury /Illness	isafe Incident Number	INC- 0001
Actual Consequence	Moderate	Potential Consequence	Moderate

Incident Short Description	Culvert worker received manual handling injury, resulting in an LTI
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Executive Summary

At approximately 2:00 PM, a contracted culvert crew was performing slab preparation works. The crew were relocating a section of reinforcing steel mesh approximately 1800 mm x 6000 mm wide and weighing 83 KG from the embankment into the slab trench using manual handling methodologies.

The IP (Injured Person) commenced a multi-person lift with two other crew members and as the load was raised from the ground to a raised position, the IP felt a sharp pain in the lower left side of their back. The lift was continued and the reinforcing steel mesh was carried to its final resting position. Although with some discomfort and restricted movement the IP continued to work for the remainder of shift ending the shift at approximately 5:00 PM and returning to camp.

The IP continued to feel discomfort throughout the evening and subsequently notified the Project Manager the following morning.

After being notified of the incident, the IP was transported to hospital for triage, assessment and treatment, and was certified as being unfit for duties for two days, resulting in an LTI.

Contributing Factors

- The SWMS did not detail the specific lifting methodology, team coordination requirements or weight management controls for handling reinforcing mesh of this size.
- The IP continued working following the onset of pain and did not immediately report the injury to the Supervisor.
- The injury was only reported the following morning continued discomfort overnight.
- The task involved lifting, carrying and positioning reinforcing mesh within a trench area, requiring awkward body positioning and force exertion.

Corrective Actions

- Assess mechanical lifting options or alternative methods for relocating reinforcing mesh and similar materials.
- Review team lifting procedures to ensure clear communication and coordination during multi-person lifts.
- Ensure SWMS specifically assess manual handling risks associated with large or awkward loads.
- Reinforce injury and incident reporting requirements with all work crews.

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations